ALBION EAST INDUSTRIAL PARK

Project Manager, Albion Economic Development Corporation

Albion, Michigan | 2024 - Present

1. SITE CONTEXT AND DEVELOPMENT CHALLENGE

The Albion East Industrial Park represented a long-identified but underdeveloped economic asset with significant potential to support industrial growth and job creation in Albion and the surrounding region. Prior to this effort, the site lacked the foundational planning, due diligence, and state-level validation required to attract investment or advance development. Critical barriers included site readiness assessments, unresolved infrastructure considerations, environmental due diligence needs, and limited alignment between stakeholders and economic development priorities. Despite regional interest in expanding industrial capacity, the absence of a coordinated development strategy left the site effectively unmarketable and unable to compete for state or private investment.

2. PROJECT LEADERSHIP, STATE COORDINATION & EXECUTION

I was the **sole project lead** for development of the East Industrial Park and all the associated activities that accompanied it. Tasked with guiding the site from an unstructured concept to a state-validated development opportunity over the course of a year. This investment readiness work and state coordination included:

- Independently identifying and sequencing the technical, regulatory, and strategic steps necessary to move the site towards investment readiness
- Managing risk and alignment with local actions and state economic development expectations
- Coordination of preliminary site analysis and due diligence planning
- Stakeholder alignment to address environmental, infrastructure, and access considerations that previously limited the site's viability.

A central component of this effort was state-level coordination with the Michigan Economic Development Corporation. I planned, developed, and led a comprehensive MEDC site visit, engaging stakeholders, preparing site materials, and facilitating discussions that positioned the East Industrial Park as a serious candidate for investment. **This engagement resulted in $1 million in initial state investment**, validating the development approach and establishing a foundation for continued site advancement and future funding.

3. INVESTMENT READINESS & STRATEGIC IMPACT

Through sustained early-stage leadership, the Albion East Industrial Park transitioned from an unvalidated site into a strategic-state-recognized development opportunity with clear next steps for advancement. The completion of foundational planning, stakeholder alignment, and state engagement reduced uncertainty around site feasibility and established the credibility required to attract public investment. The successful MEDC site visit and subsequent $1 million initial investment confirmed the site's potential.

This work positioned the East Industrial Park for continued progress by creating a shared understanding among local and state partners of the sites constraints, opportunities, and development pathways. As a result, this site is no longer aspirational, but actively positioned for long-term industrial development and economic growth.

Linkedin **AveryAMargaret@gmail.com** **(517) 929-3238**

GRANT STRATEGY & FUNDRAISING ACHIEVEMENTS

Equality Michigan | Albion Economic Development Corporation | Battle Creek Area Habitat for Humanity
2020 - Current

IMPACT SNAPSHOT

$7.5M+	40+ grants	65%	Multi-year
secured across federal, state, local, foundational, and individual funding	**awarded** supporting programs, infrastructure, and capacity	**success rate** average, which is 6.5x the national average	**Initiatives enabled** across housing, advocacy, and community development

FUNDING SCOPE & STRATEGIC ROLE

Led comprehensive grant strategy and fund development efforts securing diversified public and private funding to support organizational growth, program expansion, and long-term sustainability. Work spanned federal, state, foundational, and individual donor sources and required alignment between funding opportunities, compliance requirements, and strategic priorities. Funding leadership has spanned multiple organizations including statewide advocacy nonprofits, local economic development entities, and housing focused organizations.

GRANT & FUND DEVELOPMENT LEADERSHIP

- Led end-to-end grant strategy, prospecting, and proposal development across federal, state, foundation, and corporate funding sources
- Aligned funding strategy with organizational priorities, ensuring grants supported long-term sustainability rather than short-term activity.
- Managed complex compliance, reporting, and budget coordination requirements across multiple funding and program areas.

MAJOR GRANT & FUNDRAISING HIGHLIGHTS

- $3M in State and Federal Funding for Housing Development and Maintenance
- $2M in Foundation Funding for Housing Development
- $1M in State Funding for Industrial Development
- $800k Federal VOCA Funding for Direct Advocacy to Victims of Crime
- $500k+ Individual Fundraising Campaign for Housing Development
- $50k in Individual Fundraising Campaigns for Accessibility Programs
- $20k Fundraising Campaign for LGBTQIA2S+ Youth Education Access

IMPACT METRICS

15,000+	100+	4
Individuals Served	**Partner Organizations and Funders Engaged**	**New Staff Positions Created**

Linkedin **AveryAMargaret@gmail.com** **(517) 929-3238**

STATEWIDE TRAININGS, PANELS & KEYNOTE ENGAGEMENTS

Selected engagements demonstrating subject matter expertise and public leadership
2019 - Current

REPRESENTATIVE SPEAKING ENGAGEMENTS

- Key Note Speaker, Michigan Re:Con
- Panelist, Walsh College
- Featured Speaker, Michigan Association of Social Workers Conference
- Key Note Speaker, Michigan Human Rights Commission
- Panelist on Suicide Prevention, Mental Health, and Community Safety
- Key Note Speaker for Various Organizational Inclusivity Trainings
- Invited expert on Legal Name Changes across Michigan

INSTITUATIONAL & AUDIENCE REACH

- Delivered trainings and presentations across statewide, regional, and rural communities in Michigan
- Engaged audiences including higher education institutions, nonprofits, healthcare providers, advocates, social workers, government partners, and community members
- Represented organizations as a primary public-facing spokesperson on complex and sensitive topics.

PRIMARY TOPICS

- LGBTQIA2S+ Policy, Advocacy, and Systems Change
- Legal Name Change Navigation and Identity Documentation
- LGBTQIA2S+ Healthcare
- Rural Equity, Community Safety, and Access to Services
- Suicide Prevention, Mental Health, and Community-based Prevention Strategies
- Economic Development, Site Readiness, and Cross-Sector Collaboration

STRATEGIC IMPACT

- Increased institutional understanding of LGBTQIA2S+ legal, health, and safety issues
- Strengthened partnerships and cross-section collaboration following speaking engagements
- Supported program growth, coalition-building, and policy-aligned advocacy through public education

Linkedin **AveryAMargaret@gmail.com** **(517) 929-3238**